

Screener Columns — Data Legend

This document explains every column in the **Screener** tab and in the multi-ticker Excel export (the **Metrics** sheet of `stock-terminal-YYYYMMDD.xlsx`, produced by the "↓ Export .xlsx" button). One row = one company.

It is intended as a reference for a human or an AI assistant interpreting the exported spreadsheet. Each column lists the **Excel header**, the **field key**, what it means, and the **units of the raw exported value**.

Units cheat-sheet. The exported workbook uses **one convention for every rate**: all margins, returns, yields, growth rates, payout, short interest and price performance are stored as **decimal fractions** — multiply by 100 for a percentage. So $0.478 = 47.8\%$, $0.0038 = 0.38\%$, $0.41 = 41\%$. The other value types are: - **currency** — an absolute amount. For most tickers this is simply the company's one currency. For a foreign-reporting ticker (an ADR like WIT, which trades in USD but reports in INR), it isn't one currency: Price, Market Cap, and Diluted EPS are in the trading currency, while Enterprise Value, Revenue, Cash, Debt, Equity, EBITDA, Net Income, FCF, Basic EPS, and Dividend TTM are in the reporting currency — see the callout below and [METRICS.md §11](#). Per-share values (Price, EPS, dividends) are per single share. - **multiple (x)** — a valuation or coverage ratio (P/E, EV/EBITDA, FCF Coverage). - **ratio** — a plain liquidity ratio (Current, Quick). - **number / integer / date** — as labelled.

(The on-screen Screener **tab** shows these same metrics formatted as percentages, e.g. 47.8% , for readability. The **export** stores raw fractions so the numbers are calculation-ready and consistent with the single-company export — see [STOCK_METRICS.md](#).)

All data comes from Yahoo Finance via `yfinance` and may be delayed, restated, or missing (empty cell = `N/A`). "Good/bad" ranges are rough rules of thumb that vary by sector, business model, and growth stage — always compare against the company's own history and direct peers.

Identity & size

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units
Ticker	<code>ticker</code>	Stock symbol. Hovering the cell shows a short description of what the company is and does (from Yahoo's business summary).	text
Name	<code>name</code>	Company name.	text
Sector	<code>sector</code>	High-level sector classification.	text
Industry	<code>industry</code>	Finer industry classification.	text
Price	<code>price</code>	Latest traded share price.	currency / share
Market Cap	<code>market_cap</code>	Share price × shares outstanding — total equity value.	currency
Enterprise Value	<code>enterprise_value</code>	Market cap + total debt – cash. Cost to acquire the whole business, debt included.	currency

No currency column in this export. Unlike the single-company Excel export ([STOCK_METRICS.md](#)), this multi-ticker sheet doesn't label which currency each row's dollar figures are in. For the overwhelming majority of rows that's a non-issue — the whole sheet is one currency (USD). But for a foreign-reporting ticker in the batch (an ADR like WIT), Enterprise Value/Revenue/Cash/Debt/Equity/EBITDA/Net Income/FCF/Basic EPS/Dividend TTM are silently in that company's reporting currency (₹ for WIT), while Price/Market Cap/Diluted EPS are in its trading currency (USD) — both stored as plain numbers in the same-looking column as every other ticker's dollar figures. The screener **view** and the single-ticker deep dive both label this correctly (see [METRICS.md §11](#)); this batch export currently doesn't carry that label through, so cross-checking a foreign ticker's absolute figures here against a same-currency peer will be misleading — verify in the deep dive instead when a batch includes one.

Strategy grades (0–100 integers; higher is better)

Each stock is graded against the three long-term investing strategies documented in this directory. Grades are computed server-side from the same row metrics listed below, so an empty metric can lower a grade (missing data never helps a stock).

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Bands
S1 Triage	strategy_1	Triage framework: data-hygiene quarantine → hard kill-switches (distress, twin-negative earnings, leverage, liquidity, value destruction) → quality score across value creation, profitability, balance sheet, cash conversion. Empty cell = quarantined (missing critical data); 0 = a kill-switch fired.	≥65 Advance · 45–64 Watchlist · <45 Discard
S2 Compounder	strategy_2	Quality Compounder: returns on capital (ROIC/ROCE/ROE), margin moat, capital discipline, 5Y/10Y compounding track record, valuation sanity. Distress or twin-negative earnings caps the score at 35.	≥70 Compounder · 50–69 Quality watch · <50 Pass
S3 Defensive	strategy_3	Defensive Value: Graham-style — earnings/cash yield, asset backing (incl. P/E×P/B ≤ 22.5), financial strength, earnings quality, dividend record.	≥70 Value candidate · 50–69 Fair · <50 Expensive/weak
Strat Min	strategy_min	Minimum of the three grades — the "good under every lens" rank. Sort this column descending to find the stocks with the best rating across all strategies. Empty when any strategy could not be graded.	interpret via the per-strategy bands
S1 Flags	strategy_1_flags	Triage Stage-0/Stage-3 context flags — never disqualifying, they tell the deep dive where to look first: priced for perfection (PEG > 3, P/FCF > 40 or EV/EBITDA > 30) · suspiciously cheap (P/E < 8 or EV/EBITDA < 5 with a score ≤ 60) · ⚠ low Altman-Z (< 1.8 for an asset-light or cyclical business — a soft caution, since Altman-Z is a manufacturer model that only <i>disqualifies</i> capital-intensive names) · ⚠ low Piotroski F-Score (≤ 3 for a bank, REIT, or mortgage REIT — two of the 9 tests are biased against their intentionally high, stable leverage) · ⚠ divergent multiples / data-sanity warnings (P/B > 40, EV/EBITDA > 150, negative EV) · payout stress (payout > 60% or FCF coverage < 1.2×; equity REITs judged on FFO payout > 90% instead, mortgage REITs on payout > 100%, and banks and mortgage REITs skip the FCF leg — lending runs through operating cash flow, so GAAP FCF tracks the loan book, not the dividend) · crowded short (>15% of float) · high beta (>1.7).	empty = no warnings

Every stock is classified into one of six business-type archetypes — see [Business-type archetypes](#) for the full table — and each strategy substitutes metrics that don't fit that type. **Financials** (banks, insurance carriers, capital markets, credit services, mortgage *finance*, conglomerates — classified by *industry*; fee businesses Yahoo files under "Financial Services," like insurance brokers, exchanges/data vendors and asset managers, score on the standard rubric instead) get each strategy's ROE/net-margin/Piotroski substitution, since Altman Z, Debt/EBITDA, current ratio and ROIC are structurally meaningless for balance-sheet businesses. **Mortgage REITs** (industry "REIT — Mortgage") get their own dedicated rubric rather than the bank one — a mREIT's net margin is an income-statement artifact, not a quality signal — graded instead on dividend coverage, price vs. book value, leverage (wide agency-appropriate bands), and book-value-per-share trend, the headline mREIT quality signal.

Valuation (lower is usually cheaper; a very low multiple can signal trouble)

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read
P/E	pe	Price ÷ trailing 12-month EPS.	multiple (×)	<15 cheap-ish, 15–25 average, >25 priced for growth. Blank if loss-making.
Forward P/E	forward_pe	Price ÷ estimated next-year EPS.	multiple (×)	Below trailing P/E implies expected earnings growth.
PEG	peg	P/E ÷ expected earnings growth.	ratio	~1.0 fair for the growth; <1 potentially cheap; >2 expensive.
P/S	ps	Price ÷ trailing 12-month revenue per share.	multiple (×)	Useful when earnings are negative. <1 low, >10 rich.

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read
P/B	pb	Price ÷ book value (net assets) per share.	multiple (×)	<1 below book; 1–3 typical; high for asset-light firms.
EV/EBITDA	ev_ebitda	Enterprise value ÷ EBITDA. Capital-structure-neutral.	multiple (×)	<10 cheap, 10–15 average, >15 expensive.
P/FCF	p_fcf	Market cap ÷ free cash flow.	multiple (×)	<15 attractive, >25 expensive. Blank if FCF ≤ 0.
P/C	pc	Market cap ÷ total cash.	multiple (×)	Lower = more cash backing the valuation.
DCF Value	dcf_value	Inferred fair value per share from a 10-year two-stage FCFF DCF: latest annual FCF grown at the company's historical FCF CAGR (clamped 0–20%; flat 2.5% when no usable history), fading linearly to 2.5% terminal growth, discounted at the row's WACC; Gordon terminal value; minus debt, plus cash, ÷ shares outstanding. In the trading currency, directly comparable to Price. On-screen it sits next to Price , colored green when the model reads the stock as below fair value and red when above; hover it for the exact DCF Upside % . Sorting this column sorts by that upside — descending surfaces the most-undervalued names first. See METRICS.md §2 for the full methodology, and use the deep-dive ! DCF button for the complete working.	currency / share	Compare against Price. Blank for financials/REITs (FCFF doesn't fit), FCF ≤ 0, or WACC unavailable/≤ 3%.
DCF Upside	dcf_upside	DCF Value ÷ Price – 1. On the screener/watchlist tabs this isn't its own column — it colors the DCF Value cell, shows on hover, and is what the DCF Value column sorts by. It is a full standalone column in the exported workbook.	fraction	>0 = model reads the stock as below fair value; <0 above. Assumption-heavy — a screen for what deserves a closer look, not a target price.
EPS	eps	Trailing 12-month earnings per share.	currency / share	Higher and rising is better.

Profitability (higher is better; consistency matters as much as level)

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read (as fraction)
Net Margin	profit_margin	Net income ÷ revenue.	fraction	>0.10 solid, >0.20 excellent, negative = unprofitable.
Gross Margin	gross_margin	(Revenue – cost of goods sold) ÷ revenue.	fraction	>0.40 strong (software 0.70+, retail <0.30).
Operating Margin	operating_margin	Operating income ÷ revenue (before interest & tax).	fraction	>0.15 healthy; negative = core operations lose money.
EBITDA Margin	ebitda_margin	EBITDA ÷ revenue.	fraction	>0.20 generally strong.
ROE	roe	Net income ÷ shareholders' equity.	fraction	>0.15 good; can be inflated by leverage or thin equity.
ROA	roa	Net income ÷ total assets.	fraction	>0.05 decent; banks/utilities lower.
ROIC	roic	After-tax operating profit ÷ (debt + equity).	fraction	Creates value only when > cost of capital (~0.08–0.10). >0.15 excellent.

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read (as fraction)
ROCE	roce	EBIT ÷ (total assets – current liabilities). Pre-tax sibling of ROIC.	fraction	>0.15 strong.
WACC	wacc	Weighted average cost of capital: cost of equity via CAPM (10Y Treasury + Beta × 5.5% equity risk premium — a fixed US-market estimate, applied to every ticker regardless of domicile; see METRICS.md §3) + after-tax cost of debt.	fraction	Benchmark for ROIC; typically ~0.06–0.12. Value is created when ROIC > WACC.
Revenue/Share	revenue_per_share	Trailing 12-month revenue ÷ shares outstanding.	currency / share	Rising over time is the signal to want.
Net Income	income	Net income (trailing 12 months).	currency	Profit attributable to shareholders.
FCF	fcf	Free cash flow = operating cash flow – capex.	currency	Positive and growing is the goal.

Financial health (can the company pay its bills and survive a downturn?)

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read
Debt/Eq	debt_to_equity	Total Debt ÷ Total Equity, computed from the two columns in this row so they reconcile.	fraction	<1.0 conservative, 1.0–2.0 moderate, >2.0 aggressive (ex banks/utilities).
Debt/Eq (MRQ)	debt_to_equity_mrq	Yahoo's pre-computed Debt/Equity from its most-recent-quarter balance sheet.	fraction	Same ranges; differs from Debt/Eq when the latest quarter has moved since fiscal year-end.
Debt/EBITDA	debt_ebitda	Total Debt ÷ EBITDA — years of EBITDA needed to repay all debt.	multiple (x)	<3× comfortable, 3–4× watch, >4–5× heavily leveraged.
LT Debt/Eq	lt_debt_to_equity	Long-term debt ÷ shareholders' equity.	fraction	As above, long-term portion only.
Current Ratio	current_ratio	Current assets ÷ current liabilities.	ratio	>1 covers near-term bills; 1.5–3 comfortable; <1 possible squeeze.
Quick Ratio	quick_ratio	(Current assets – inventory) ÷ current liabilities.	ratio	>1 strong; stricter than current ratio.
Total Cash	total_cash	Cash + short-term investments.	currency	Dry powder; compare to total debt.
Total Debt	total_debt	Short- + long-term borrowings.	currency	Judge against cash, equity, EBITDA.
Total Equity	total_equity	Assets – liabilities (book value).	currency	Negative is a red flag.
EBITDA	ebitda	Net Income + Interest + Tax + Depreciation & Amortization — built up from the bottom line, not down from revenue (Yahoo's TTM figure — the same one behind Debt/EBITDA and EBITDA/FCF).	currency	Proxy for operating cash earnings; compare to debt and FCF.
EBITDA/FCF	ebitda_fcf	EBITDA ÷ Free Cash Flow — how much EBITDA it takes to produce a dollar of free cash.	multiple (x)	Closer to 1× = cleaner cash conversion; high values flag capex/tax/working-capital drag.

Dividends (sustainability matters more than headline yield)

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read (as fraction)
Yield	div_yield	Forward annual dividend ÷ price.	fraction	<0.02 low, 0.02–0.04 typical, 0.04–0.06 high, >0.07–0.08 often signals cut risk.
5Y Avg Yield	five_year_avg_yield	Average yield over the past 5 years.	fraction	Context for whether today's yield is unusually high/low.
Payout Ratio	payout_ratio	Dividends ÷ earnings.	fraction	<0.60 comfortable, 0.60–0.80 watch, >1.0 paying more than it earns.
Div Growth 3Y	div_growth_3y	Annualized dividend CAGR over 3 years.	fraction	Steady positive growth = healthy payer.
Div Growth 5Y	div_growth_5y	Annualized dividend CAGR over 5 years.	fraction	As above, longer track record.
Div Estimate	dividend_estimate	Forward annual dividend per share (run-rate).	currency / share	—
Div TTM	dividend_ttm	Dividends actually paid per share, trailing 12m.	currency / share	—
FCF Coverage	fcf_coverage	Free cash flow ÷ dividends paid.	multiple (x)	≥1.2 safe, 0.8–1.2 tight, <0.8 under-covered.
Yrs Div Increase	years_div_increase	Consecutive completed years of rising dividends.	integer (years)	10+ strong culture, 25+ "dividend aristocrat".
Ex-Dividend Date	ex_dividend_date	Buy before this date to receive the next dividend.	date (YYYY-MM-DD)	—

Risk (volatility, crowding, distress signals)

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units	Rough read
Beta	beta	Sensitivity vs. the market (S&P 500).	number	1 = moves with market; >1 amplified; <1 stabler; <0 inverse.
Short Interest	short_interest	Shares sold short ÷ public float.	fraction	<0.05 normal, 0.05–0.10 elevated, >0.10–0.20 heavily shorted.
Days to Cover	days_to_cover	Short interest ÷ average daily volume.	number (days)	<1 easy to cover; >5–7 crowded short, squeeze potential.
Altman Z-Score	altman_z	Bankruptcy-risk gauge (higher = safer).	number	>2.99 safe, 1.81–2.99 grey, <1.81 distress. Ignored for financials/REITs/mortgage REITs; a soft flag (not a kill) for asset-light and cyclical names.
Piotroski F-Score	piotroski_f	Fundamental strength across 9 tests (1 pt each).	integer 0–9	7–9 strong, 4–6 middling, 0–3 weak. Replaced by ROE/net-margin for financials/REITs, and by book-value-per-share trend for mortgage REITs.

Performance (price return — excludes dividends)

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units
Perf YTD	perf_ytd	Price return since Jan 1 this year.	fraction
Perf 1Y	perf_1y	Price return over the last 1 year.	fraction
Perf 3Y	perf_3y	Price return over the last 3 years.	fraction

Excel header	Field key	Meaning	Units
Perf 5Y	perf_5y	Price return over the last 5 years.	fraction
Perf 10Y	perf_10y	Price return over the last 10 years.	fraction

These are price appreciation only, so a high-yield stock's true total return is higher than shown.

Other sheets in the screener export

- **Price History** — daily closing price (last 1 year) for each ticker, aligned by date. One column per ticker; values in the company's reporting currency.
- **Financials** — annual income statement, stacked per ticker. Rows are line items (Total Revenue, Net Income, ...); columns are fiscal-year-end dates. Values in reporting currency. Note: the oldest annual column is often blank — Yahoo's free feed reliably populates ~4 fiscal years.

See [STOCK_METRICS.md](#) for the single-company deep-dive export, which uses the **same fraction convention**.